

August 13, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care  
Provider Appeals Department

**RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Keitha Turner (MRN MUSC5870574), Claim MUSC-6CD1-3**

|                          |                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Patient</b>           | Keitha Turner (DOB 2004-07-22)                                                                                      |
| <b>MRN</b>               | MUSC5870574                                                                                                         |
| <b>Member ID / Group</b> | AMB999437436 / GRP-60820                                                                                            |
| <b>Claim number</b>      | MUSC-6CD1-3                                                                                                         |
| <b>Date of service</b>   | 2026-04-28                                                                                                          |
| <b>Procedure billed</b>  | CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity                                       |
| <b>Primary diagnosis</b> | J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified                                                              |
| <b>Denied amount</b>     | \$1,161.74                                                                                                          |
| <b>Denial code</b>       | CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer. |
| <b>Appeal deadline</b>   | 2026-09-12                                                                                                          |

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

**SUMMARY OF APPEAL**

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of Keitha Turner (Member ID: AMB999437436) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-6CD1-3 for services rendered on April 28, 2026, at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center. The claim was denied on June 14, 2026, under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the accompanying payer remark stating: "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment of the denied amount of \$1,161.74.

**CLINICAL BACKGROUND**

Ms. Turner is a 22-year-old established female patient with a documented history of recurrent acute upper respiratory infections, including multiple prior episodes of acute viral pharyngitis. Her medical history also includes a confirmed elevated shrimp IgE antibody level, an active epinephrine auto-injector prescription, and ongoing fexofenadine therapy, indicating a clinically complex allergic profile that has been actively managed over time through allergy screening and a sustained course of subcutaneous immunotherapy. On April 28, 2026, Ms. Turner presented to Dr. James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465) at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center for an established outpatient visit. The encounter was coded as CPT 99214, reflecting an office visit of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified).

## **BASIS FOR APPEAL**

CPT code 99214 is appropriately assigned to an established patient visit requiring moderate medical decision-making. Given Ms. Turner's history of recurrent upper respiratory infections and her underlying allergic condition — including active prescriptions for both an antihistamine and an epinephrine auto-injector — evaluation and management of an acute upper respiratory infection in this patient reasonably involves a higher level of clinical judgment than a straightforward presentation would require. The treating physician's assessment of a patient with a known allergic background presenting with acute respiratory symptoms is consistent with the complexity level reflected in the 99214 code selection.

The payer's reliance on RARC N115, referencing a Local Coverage Determination, is noted; however, LCD-based denials are applicable primarily to Medicare fee-for-service claims. This claim was submitted under a Marketplace plan governed by the Ambetter from Absolute Total Care Advantage plan (Group GRP-60820), and the application of an LCD framework to a commercial Marketplace claim does not constitute a valid basis for denial under that plan's coverage terms. Furthermore, the denial does not identify any specific documentation deficiency beyond a general assertion that medical necessity was not established. MUSC Health maintains that the clinical record, including the patient's documented history and the complexity of her ongoing medical management, supports the medical necessity of this encounter.

## **REQUESTED ACTION**

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care conduct a thorough clinical review of the complete medical record for the April 28, 2026 encounter, including Ms. Turner's documented history of recurrent upper respiratory infections and her active allergic condition management. We request that the denial be reversed in full and that payment be issued at the allowed amount of \$562.31, consistent with the plan's contracted rate. Should additional clinical documentation be required to complete this review, MUSC Health is prepared to submit it promptly through the secure provider portal in advance of the September 12, 2026 appeal deadline.

Respectfully submitted,

**Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC**

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management  
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services  
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

## **Enclosures**

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record